

SAALR

Research-Grade Options Analytics for Retail

Honest ML · Multi-Broker · Multi-Geography

Pre-revenue. Solo founder. Three codebases shipped. *Signal-validation experiment scheduled Q3 2026.*

Seed Round | \$2M target | 24-month plan to \$1M ARR

Retail options: toys, scams, and a missing middle.

Across the US and India, the same gap: tools are either too simple to give edge, or too hyped to be honest.

The Loss Rate

India: 91% of retail F&O traders lose (SEBI 2024). US: ~70% of retail options traders lose (SEC). Same broken pattern, two geographies.

Toys for Retail

Robinhood, Streak: no vol surface, no Greeks aggregation, no honest performance reporting. Retail gets the broker, not the brain.

Scams Above

"AI signal" Discords, options-tip Telegram groups, alpha-promising YouTubers. The trust deficit is real and growing.

Missing Middle

Bloomberg-grade analytics sit behind \$30K/year terminals. No honest, research-grade options platform exists at retail price points across both geographies.

Sources: SEBI Circular Feb 2025 · SEBI F&O Study 2024 · NSE Market Pulse Dec 2025 · OCC Retail Options Data

Institutional tooling at retail price points.

Open-source ML, broker APIs, and LLM-augmented sentiment have collapsed the cost curve. **Defensible value now lives in integration depth, honest model reporting, brand of rigor, and multi-geography distribution — not magic AI.**

FROM	TO
Robinhood-simple	Research-grade
"AI says buy"	Honest models
Black-box signals	Glass-box math
US-only or India-only	Both, one codebase

One platform. Honest analytics. US first.

Saarl is the unified options analytics platform for serious retail traders. Vol surface and Greeks for free, sentiment-aware probability for premium, broker-integrated execution for live trading.

1 Pro-Grade Analytics

Vol surface, Greeks, multi-leg P&L, sentiment-adjusted POP.
Bloomberg-grade depth at \$15-49/month.

2 Honest ML Engine

GARCH for vol. Monte Carlo for POP. FinBERT for sentiment. LSTM reported against ARIMA baseline. No "AI says buy" buttons.

3 Education Funnel

OptionsAcademy: 50+ free modules. Engaged retail traders at near-zero CAC. Same playbook as Zerodha Varsity and TastyTrade.

4 Multi-Broker Reach

US: Alpaca, IBKR. India: Zerodha, Angel One. One platform, two markets. We never custody user capital.

Four sources of defensibility — none of them magic AI.

WHAT COMPETITORS LACK	WHAT WE ARE BUILDING
Integrated vol surface + Greeks	IV by strike × expiry composed with portfolio-level Greeks aggregation
Sentiment-adjusted Monte Carlo POP	GARCH vol × FinBERT score composed into a single drift input
ARIMA-baselined ML reporting	Failed models retired; baseline-vs-model performance shown in UI
50+ module education library	OptionsAcademy: Greeks, IV rank, strategy mechanics — no BS
Multi-broker reach	Alpaca + IBKR (US), Zerodha + Angel One (India), one codebase
Brand of intellectual honesty	Public commitment: no "AI says buy." Earned trust in a scammy market.

Why this compounds: *integration depth + brand equity + content library + multi-geography are slow to build and slow to copy. Magic AI is not.*

Three codebases shipped solo, pre-revenue.

CODEBASES SHIPPED

OptionsAcademy

Live — public, free, no monetization

OptionsWorld (US MVP)

Live at optionsworld.ai — GARCH, FinBERT, Monte Carlo, multi-leg builder

Options Academy on Azure

Live at optionsacademy.ai — clean Zerodha-inspired landing, full app behind it

ENGINE COMPONENTS BUILT

- GARCH vol forecasting
- FinBERT news sentiment with recency half-life
- Monte Carlo POP with sentiment-adjusted drift
- LSTM vs. ARIMA harness
- Multi-leg builder + payoff diagrams
- Vol surface + Greeks aggregation

BROKER INTEGRATIONS (CODE COMPLETE)

US: Alpaca, IBKR, Robinhood scaffolding

India: Zerodha (Kite Connect), Angel One, ICICI Direct, HDFC Securities

0 paying customers. Public sites live but pre-marketing. RA licensing: personal Month 3 / corporate Month 12.

The Saalr platform unifies these three into one product post-seed.

Earn the right to claim engine validation.

The next 12 months are not "scale." They are proving the engine works — and retiring it publicly if it doesn't.

Phase 0 Q3 2026 · 8 weeks	Signal validation GARCH OOS vs. naïve baseline on SPY/QQQ. FinBERT lift on 30-min forward IV. Holdout test. Public results. If signals fail, models retired; product repositions around vol surface + Greeks + education.
Phase 1 Q4 2026 · 12 weeks	First paid US cohort OptionsWorld free → \$15 paid funnel. Target: first 50 paying users. Measure real CAC, retention, ARPU. No claims until measured.
Phase 2 Q1–Q2 2027	India launch India entity stood up, RA filing in progress, Zerodha integration first user. Sensibull-adjacent positioning. Target: first 50 Indian paying users.
Phase 3 Q3–Q4 2027	Series A readiness \$1M ARR run-rate. 70%+ retention measured on real cohorts.

18-month targets, not actuals.

We have not hit any of these yet. We are raising to hit them.

M E T R I C	T O D A Y	T A R G E T (M O N T H 1 8 P O S T - S E E D)
Free users	< 100	5,000
Paying users	0	200 (\$15 + \$49 mix)
ARR	\$0	\$80K
Blended ARPU	n/a	\$33
Retention (6-mo)	n/a	70%+
Geographies live	US (partial)	US + India
Brokers user-validated	0	4 (Alpaca, IBKR, Zerodha, Angel One)
ML claims	Built, not validated	GARCH + FinBERT validated OOS, public

Unit-economics targets (\$33 ARPU, \$22 CAC, \$190 LTV, ~6× LTV/CAC) follow US B2C fintech benchmarks. They are not yet measured — Phase 1 produces the first real cohort.

Two big markets. Mature ML stack. Trust collapsing on incumbents.

10M+

US retail options traders

4× volume since 2020 (OCC)

9.6M

India retail F&O traders

4× algo growth since 2020 (NSE FY24)

\$0

Marginal cost of the ML stack

FinBERT / FinGPT / GARCH open-source; LLM APIs cheap



Retail trust in AI-trading is falling

Overfit strategies failing publicly — "no AI says buy" cuts through

Sources: NSE Market Pulse Dec 2025 · OCC Retail Options Data · SEBI 2024

TAM · SAM · SOM

T A M

\$21.4B

Global retail trading software; options analytics is the fastest-growing slice.

S A M

\$3.2B

US + India retail options tools (~16M traders × \$200/yr).

S O M

\$480M

~1.2M paying users at \$33/mo blended ARPU by Year 5 (15% SAM penetration).

Sources: Grand View Research 2026 · NSE FY24 · OCC · FIA

Code complete, not yet validated. Where we sit.

Capability	Saarl	Streak (IN)	OptionsAI (US)	TastyTrade (US)
Honest ML reporting	Planned ✓	X	Partial	X
Vol surface + Greeks	Built ✓	X	✓	Partial
Sentiment-adjusted POP	Built ✓	X	Partial	X
Multi-broker reach	Built ✓	Broker-tied	✓	Broker-tied
Education funnel	Built ✓	X	X	✓
US + India coverage	Built ✓	X	X	X
Free tier + paid	Planned ✓	✓	Partial	✓

Legend: Legend: Built = product code shipped, user-validation pending. Code complete = engineering done, no production user has exercised it yet. Planned = roadmap. No "shipped & validated with paying users" claim anywhere yet.

Solo today. Hiring the gaps with the seed.



Sreekanth Payyavula

Founder & CEO

IIT · IIM Calcutta · EPAT (QuantInsti)

20+ years engineering leadership

Walmart · Verizon · AT&T · Infosys

30 years personal trading

Indian + US equity and options markets

Shipped solo: 3 production codebases

POST-SEED HIRING PLAN

1

CTO / Co-Founder

Senior eng with quant/ML background. Owns architecture, ML pipelines, broker rails. Top of hiring list.

2

Head of Growth

B2C growth lead with US + India fintech experience. Owns free → paid conversion.

3

Senior quant/ML engineer

US-based. Vol modelling, sentiment pipelines, OOS testing harness.

4

Content lead — OptionsAcademy

Education funnel ownership; 50+ modules to 100+, weekly cadence.

5

India ops lead

Entity setup, RA filing, Zerodha/Angel One integrations live.

ML where it adds signal. Stats where it doesn't.

No "AI says buy" buttons — now or ever.

Shipped (validation pending)

- GARCH for volatility (mean-reverting, forecastable)
- Monte Carlo with GARCH vol for POP
- FinBERT sentiment with recency half-life
- LSTM reported alongside ARIMA baseline

Validation in progress · Q3 2026

- OOS lift testing on SPY 30-min forward IV
- Holdout periods, t-stat reporting
- Retire-on-fail discipline
- Public reporting — including failures

Honest guardrails (now and forever)

- Low-confidence sentiment defaults to neutral
- No "AI predicts UP" buttons; no signal subs
- Failed models retired publicly
- UI shows model vs. baseline vs. random

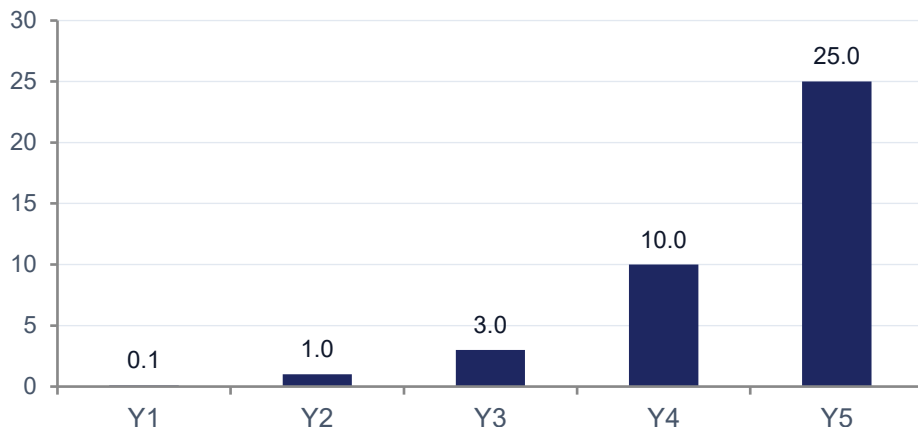
Technical foundation

- Multi-cloud: Azure + GCP · Docker · CI/CD
- Broker abstraction layer reused across rails
- Open-source: arch · HF · PyTorch · numpy/numba
- SOC 2 prep post-seed

■ PROJECTIONS

Projections, not actuals. Year 1 = seed close.

Targeted ARR (\$M)



PRICING

Free

\$0

OptionsAcademy + basic vol surface

Pro

\$15/mo

Full analytics, single broker

Premium

\$49/mo

Multi-broker · sentiment-adjusted POP
· portfolio analytics

UNIT ECONOMICS (target, unmeasured)

\$33/mo

Blended ARPU

\$22

CAC

\$190

LTV

~6×

LTV / CAC

72→82%+

Gross margin

Growth assumptions follow US + India retail-fintech benchmarks. Not guaranteed. Sources: OCC · NSE FY24 · B2C SaaS public comparables.

\$2M seed • 18 months runway

\$2M

Seed • Institutional + strategic angels

USE OF FUNDS

Engineering & hiring	40%
Growth	25%
Sales & BD	15%
Infrastructure	10%
Ops	10%

MILESTONES WE COMMIT TO

M3

Signal validation results published — kill or confirm
GARCH/FinBERT alpha

M6

First 50 paying US users • real CAC/retention measured

M12

\$50k ARR - India launch initiated

M18

\$80K ARR • 5K free / 200 paying users

M24

\$1M ARR • ~30K free / ~2,500 paying users

M30

\$3M ARR (Series A trigger)

WHAT WE WON'T DO: custody user capital • sell "AI says buy" signals • claim engine validation before it exists • onboard users to live trading before paper-trade validation

SAALR

Honest options analytics for retail traders.

US first. India next.

Sreekanth Payyavula

Founder & CEO · IIT · IIM Calcutta · EPAT Certified · 20+ yrs AI & Eng Leadership

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